

MODDABLE CHESS · VARIANT 129 OF 153

# Shinobi+

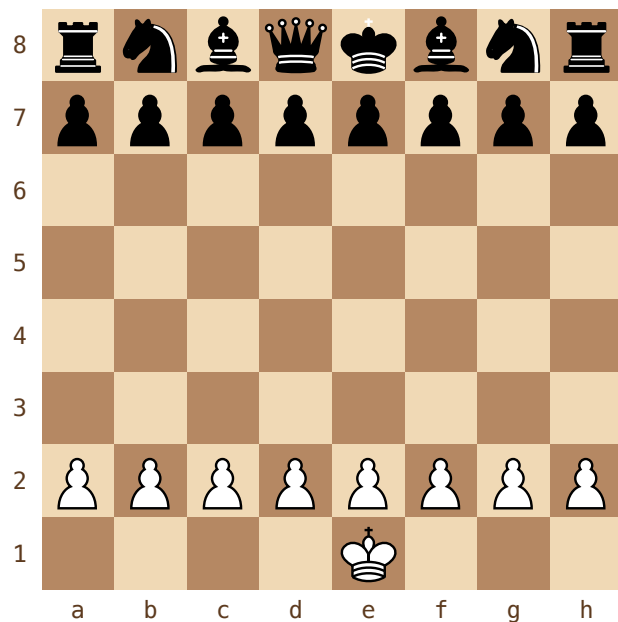
**8×8**

BOARD

**2**

PLAYERS

# SHINOBI CHESS+



*Shinobi+ – starting position*

Shinobi Chess+ (Shinobi+) is the rebalanced edition of Shinobi Chess, designed by Couch Tomato (2021). NNUE engine analysis revealed the Clan had a significant advantage in the base game, so Shinobi+ redistributes the Clan's starting pieces and adds a new Fox piece. The Clan now moves first.

See also: [Shinobi Chess](#) – the base game.

## THE TWO ARMIES

**Kingdom (Black):** Standard FIDE army – King, Queen, 2 Rooks, 2 Bishops, 2 Knights, 8 Pawns. Kingdom Pawns promote on reaching **rank 6** of the board (earlier than standard chess rank 8).

**Clan (White/Pink, moves first):** Shogi-inspired army with most pieces starting in hand.

## STARTING POSITION

**Kingdom (Black) on board:** Standard FIDE setup on ranks 7–8.

**Clan (White/Pink) on board:**

- ♦ Kage (K) – royal piece, moves as King – starts at **e1**
- ♦ 8 Clan Pawns – on rank 2 (a2–h2)

**Clan hand (available for drops from move 1):**

- ♦ 1 Ninja (J) – Archbishop (Bishop+Knight)
- ♦ 1 Dragon (D) – Dragon King (Rook+King)
- ♦ 1 Fox (F) – Dragon Horse (Bishop+King) – new piece in Shinobi+
- ♦ 1 Captain © – King movement, non-royal
- ♦ 1 Lance (L) – forward-only slider
- ♦ 1 Wooden Horse (H) – forward-only Knight
- ♦ 1 Monk (M) – Ferz (one square diagonally)

**FEN:** rnbqkbnr/pppppppp/8/8/8/8/PPPPPPPP/4K3[JDFCLHM] w kq - 0 1

(Uppercase = Clan/White. [JDFCLHM]= Clan hand: Ninja, Dragon, Fox, Captain, Lance, Wooden Horse, Monk. w = Clan moves first. kq = Kingdom castling rights.)

#### KEY DIFFERENCES FROM BASE SHINOBI

| FEATURE                | SHINOBI       | SHINOBI+                |
|------------------------|---------------|-------------------------|
| First mover            | Kingdom       | <b>Clan</b>             |
| Clan starting layout   | More on board | Most in hand            |
| Clan promotion ranks   | 6–8           | 7–8                     |
| Kingdom pawn promotion | Rank 8        | <b>Rank 6</b>           |
| Fox piece              | No            | <b>Yes</b>              |
| Perpetual check        | Draw          | <b>Loss</b> for checker |

#### CLAN PIECES

**Kage (K):** Moves as King. Royal piece. Wins via campmate (reach rank 8 safely).

**Pawn (P):** Moves as a standard chess Pawn. Promotes to **Captain** on reaching rank 7 or 8.

**Ninja (J):** Moves as Bishop or Knight (Archbishop). Does not promote.

**Dragon (D):** Moves as Rook or King (Dragon King). Does not promote.

**Fox (F):** Moves as Bishop or King (Dragon Horse). Does not promote. New in Shinobi+.

**Captain ©:** Moves as King, non-royal. Does not promote.

**Lance (L):** Slides any number of squares forward. Promotes to Knight on reaching ranks 7–8.

**Wooden Horse (H):** Jumps forward and sideways like a Knight, but only the two forward-moving Knight destinations. Promotes to Knight on reaching ranks 7–8.

**Monk (M):** Moves one square diagonally (Ferz). Promotes to Bishop on reaching ranks 7–8.

## DROP RULES

Clan pieces drop on the Clan's own half of the board (ranks 1–4) only. No piece may be dropped on a square that places the dropping player's own royal piece in check. Standard restrictions apply: Pawns cannot be dropped on rank 1 (no forward move), Lances cannot be dropped on rank 1, Wooden Horses cannot be dropped on ranks 1–2.

## GENERAL RULES

- 1 **Clan moves first.**
- 2 **Campmate:** moving your Kage or King to the opponent's last rank without landing in check wins.
- 3 **Stalemate:** loss for the player who cannot move.
- 4 **Perpetual check** (same position checked 4 times) is a loss for the checker.
- 5 **Non-check repetition** is a draw.
- 6 Clan cannot castle.

## ATTRIBUTION

Shinobi Chess+ was designed by Couch Tomato (2021). Rules documented from [pychess.org/variants/shinobiplus](https://pychess.org/variants/shinobiplus).